Brett Lee is another Australian player whom I've got to know pretty well, and he is the only Aussie I have befriended outside of the IPL. Interestingly, our friendship started when I left my pants at his digs. No. Let me explain …

During the 2006 tour to Australia, the one just prior to them coming to South Africa, his fiancée, Liz, got on really well with my fiancée, Tenielle, when all the wives and girlfriends sat together at the Perth Test. Anyway, so the two girls are chatting and Tenielle asks Liz about laundry, as the hotel laundry service never seemed to get the grass stains out of one's cricket kit.

All the Aussie guys were staying in hotel suites, with their own washing machines and other facilities, so Liz says, 'Well, bring it over to me. I'll clean Herschelle's pants.' Talk about the irony: my kit being washed by Australia's opening bowler.

Fortunately Brett 'Binga' Lee found it quite funny as well, and when I was batting, every time I got to his end, I'd hear, 'Nice pants, mate. Who is doing your laundry then? It's a fine job.' So I was laughing my damn head off when I should have been concentrating, because moments later he was going to be steaming in, trying to knock my head off.

Since then we've become quite good mates. When I was still with Tenielle, we used to go out quite a lot with Brett and Liz on double dates, but I've never really socialised in the same way with any of the other players. Other than Adam Gilchrist, Binga is probably the friendliest Aussie I've played. Odd … like Tenielle and me, he and Liz are now also divorced.

Of the English guys, I know Jonathan Trott the best. He's essentially still a South African oke, and we were teammates for a couple of games at Western Province. So, ja, we've had a couple of drinks and quite a few laughs together.

Despite his South African roots, I haven't interacted much with Kevin Pietersen. It's pretty clear, though, that the best thing he ever did – and the best thing he did for his cricket – was to go to the UK. I remember him when he played here – no great shakes whatsoever. He was just this guy playing for Natal B – an ordinary off-spinner and an average batsman. So, when I first heard his name mentioned in connection with the England team, I was somewhat surprised, to put it politely.

The West Indians come across as a fairly arrogant lot, swaggering around in their fancy clothes, with the whole bling vibe going on, but – and this is why I love the IPL – once you get to know the guys, they are not like that at